DECO3500 · EXHIBITION

Pally

A Discord bot for better social gameplay

SOCIAL COMPLIANCE IN GAMING



01 Domain & Opportunity

Social Compliance in Gaming

Influence in gaming groups isn't shared equally. More outgoing and influential players often lead, or even dominate, the decisions; others may go along to avoid awkwardness or keep the group atmosphere.



02 What We Heard

Power to decide

"Maybe the person who organized the session, or... who have more influence."

— Interview 4

Stronger voices shape decisions; quieter ones get overlooked.

Power to evaluate

"If the teammate is someone I'm not acquainted with... we just keep it or observe."

— Interview 1

Some hold back to avoid causing discomfort in the group.

Power to say no

"I'm already thinking about stopping, but my friends... say come on, one more game."

— Interview 2

Saying no is possible, but social pressure makes it hard.

03 Design Journey

An iterative process from research to Pally.

Reconsidering the domain
From game addiction to social compliance (tutor discussion + literature review)

Refining the prototype
Based on research findings and team discussion

Development refinement
Tutor feedback → fair random rotation, controlled vocabulary and other improvements

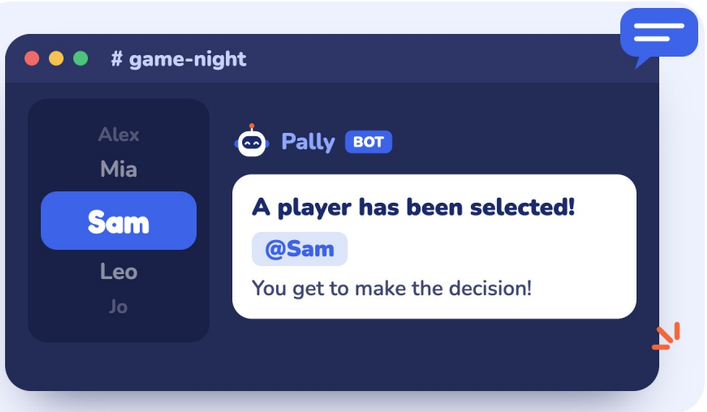
Research → Interviews → Concept → Prototype → User Testing → Development → Pally

04 The Solution: Pally

A Discord group bot with three playful features for everyday gaming interactions.

1 Random Pick

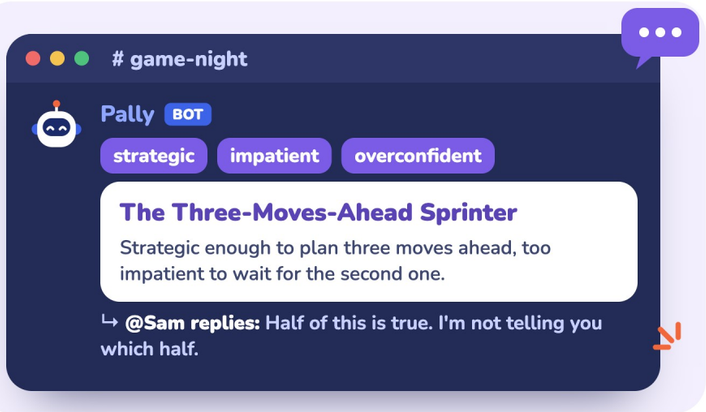
Let someone make the call.



Randomly selects a group member to make a decision, helping distribute opportunities more evenly.

2 Trait Picker

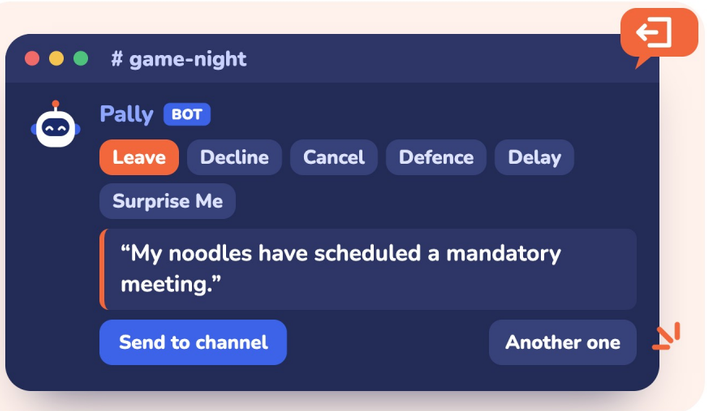
Share (anonymous) feedback.



Choose from a wide range of curated traits to generate a playful, aggregated description. The initiator stays anonymous.

3 Excuse Generator

A lighter way to say no.



Generates humorous, ready-to-send messages to help express the desire to say no, reducing the awkwardness.

05 Design Mechanisms

How Pally translates design insights into interaction details.

Anonymous initiation
The initiator is not publicly shown in Random Pick and Trait Picker. Excuse messages are generated privately and only posted after confirmation.

→ **Let the system, rather than a specific user, mediate the interaction and reduce social pressure.**

Fair random rotation
Uses a weighted rotation algorithm instead of pure random selection. Members who have not been selected have a higher chance next time.

→ **Maintain randomness while providing more balanced opportunities.**

Avoid insulting language
Players choose from a set of preset trait words, and insulting words are filtered out. Choices are turned into a short, playful description.

→ **Reduce the risk of direct insults and keep the atmosphere light-hearted and playful.**

06 User Evaluation

5 participants · Real gaming groups · Semi-structured sessions · Analysed with Groupware Heuristics

Random Pick

Gives quieter members a voice.

"Very fair. I think Random Pick is probably the best of the three features."



— Participant 2

- ✓ Helps distribute decision-making opportunities more evenly.
- ! Does not fully change who usually holds influence in the group.

Trait Picker

Encourages fun, with some limits to anonymity.

"Once a slightly abrupt review appears... very easy for them to guess it was me."



— Participant 3

- ✓ Lowered the barrier to give feedback and was seen as fun and entertaining.
- ! In familiar groups, users may still guess the initiator's identity.

Excuse Generator

Makes it easier to say no to others.

"If there were no such feature, I would definitely have some pressure."



— Participant 1

- ✓ Helps make the intention to leave more visible and acceptable.
- ! Does not guarantee a smooth exit — others may still try to convince the user to stay.

AI acknowledgement: some visual elements were created with the assistance of AI tools.